



REVITAL PRODUCTIONS

Business Operations Gaps & Plan

What's missing compared to a typical growing agency, and the concrete next step for each remaining gap.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

Four Gaps, One Already Closed

This started from a simple question: what do other agencies/businesses typically have that this Hub doesn't yet? Four gaps came out of that review. One is already built and shipped as of this document. The other three all point back to real third-party software (from the existing Software & Insurance Wishlist and Technology Stack & Future-Proof Growth Plan reference docs) rather than something to build - so the "next step" for each is a tool decision, not a code change.

Update, August 15, 2026: QuickBooks is now set up (on the Free plan), and the Simple Start upgrade (\$38/mo) is in progress specifically to get Stripe transactions syncing automatically. That resolves the "should we adopt QuickBooks" question underneath Gaps 2 and 4 below - see each section for what's still actually open now that it's narrower.

1. Failed-Payment Alerts

Status: **Done**

The gap: a client's card getting declined only showed up as a quiet status change in Contract & Invoice Tracker's Recurring Billing column - nothing actually told anyone it happened.

What was built: the Stripe webhook now sends an email to invoices@revitalproductions.com the moment an invoice.payment_failed event comes in, with the amount, attempt number, and a direct link to the invoice in Stripe. Tagged [TEST] in the subject when it's a test-mode failure so it can't be mistaken for a real declined card. No further action needed here.

2. Accounts Payable / Expense Tracking

Status: **Open** - narrower than before, see update

The gap: Contract & Invoice Tracker covers money coming IN from clients, but there's no equivalent tracked workflow for money going OUT to vendors/contractors - what's owed, to whom, and when it's due. Right now that's just static forms (Contractor-Vendor Information Sheet, Direct Deposit ACH Authorization) with no tracking layer behind them.

Update: QuickBooks Free is already active, and Simple Start (\$38/mo) is being purchased now for Stripe sync - so "whether to adopt QuickBooks at all" is settled. What's still open is narrower: Simple Start doesn't include bill-pay/AP tracking (that's Essentials-only, see table below), so the real remaining decision is whether current vendor/contractor volume justifies jumping straight to Essentials, or whether the Hub-native option covers it more cheaply until it does.

Option	Est. Cost	Trade-off
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QuickBooks Essentials	\$65-75/mo	Native bill-pay/AP tracking - Simple Start (\$35-38/mo) doesn't include this, bill pay is Essentials-only. Its built-in P&L/cash-flow reports also double as the answer to Gap 4 below - one subscription solves two gaps. Already flagged in the Technology Stack & Future-Proof Growth Plan as a headcount/revenue-triggered upgrade.
Hub-native AP tracker	\$0 (build time only)	Mirrors Contract & Invoice Tracker's own UI/workflow for outgoing bills instead of incoming ones. No new subscription, but doesn't get you real accounting/reporting the way QuickBooks does.

Recommendation: decide whether current vendor/contractor volume justifies the jump to QuickBooks Essentials for native bill-pay now, or wait per the Tech Stack Plan's own sequencing (tied to headcount/revenue, not urgent today) and lean on the Hub-native option in the meantime.

Noted for later: now that QuickBooks is in use, the Hub could pull a read-only summary of it in - vendor bills sitting alongside what clients owe, so both sides of cash flow are visible in one place, the same way Stripe billing already surfaces inside Contract & Invoice Tracker. Either a small integration against QuickBooks Online's own API, or a lighter-weight Zapier automation syncing specific events (a new bill pushing a Hub notification, for example). Not something to build until it's clear which parts of QuickBooks are worth surfacing here versus just living in QuickBooks itself.

3. Internal HR / Payroll

Status: **Open** - tool decision needed

The gap: "Onboarding" inside the Hub is entirely client-facing. There's nothing for bringing on a new employee or contractor internally - no payroll, no PTO tracking, no internal onboarding checklist, no review cycle.

Option	Est. Cost	Best fit when...
Gusto	~\$40 base + \$6/person/mo	Simplest path at current size (3 people per the Business Phase Roadmap) - payroll plus basic HR in one place. The natural first step per the Tech Stack Plan.
BambooHR	Custom quote	Stronger dedicated HR/onboarding workflows if payroll ends up handled elsewhere.
Rippling	Custom quote, pricier	Most powerful (HR + IT + payroll unified) but overkill until headcount grows well past today's size.

Recommendation: Gusto first, matching the Tech Stack Plan's own framing for a 3-person team.

4. Financial / P&L Reporting

Status: **Open** - narrower now that QuickBooks is active

The gap: Agency Health Dashboard tracks client health (delivery, engagement, risk flags) - it was never meant to show whole-business financials. There's no revenue trend, MRR, or cash-flow view anywhere in the Hub.

Update: QuickBooks Free already includes basic P&L, and Simple Start (being purchased now) adds Stripe sync on top of that - but real cash-flow/class-tracking reporting is still an Essentials-tier feature. Recommendation: if Gap 2's decision lands on Essentials for bill-pay, its fuller P&L and cash-flow reports likely close this gap too without a second subscription. Productive (agency-specific profitability/resourcing tool from the Tech Stack Plan) is the fallback if that reporting still ends up too generic once you're using it.

None of the three open gaps are urgent - each is a tool subscription decision tied to headcount/revenue growth, consistent with how the Software & Insurance Wishlist and Technology Stack & Future-Proof Growth Plan already sequence everything else. The time-sensitive one (failed payments going unnoticed) is already closed.

Last updated: August 15, 2026 | Revital Productions

UPDATE — SEPTEMBER 2026

Headcount

One correction to this plan based on a decision made this session.

Gusto recommendation

Revision note: Team size is now 4 people (was 3, per the Business Phase Roadmap baseline this page used), with a possible 5th joining soon. Re-check the Gusto cost estimate and “simplest path at current size” framing against actual current headcount before treating this recommendation as still current.